



Breezy and very cold 28/15 • Tomorrow: Cloudy 26/14 B6

Democracy Dies in Darkness

MONDAY, JANUARY 20, 2025 • \$4

On Day 1, dozens of orders are expected

Trump is said to be set to take action on border, drilling and DEI policies

BY MARIANNA SOTOMAYOR, JACQUELINE ALEMANY AND HANNAH KNOWLES

President-elect Donald Trump said Sunday night that he will sign “dozens of executive orders” within hours of taking office on Monday, in an attempt to render many actions taken by the Biden administration over the last four years “null and void.”

Stephen Miller, Trump’s incoming White House deputy chief of staff for policy, briefed congressional Republican leaders on the broad contours of what Trump is expected to sign, including sweeping changes related to the southern border, energy and the federal government workforce, said two people familiar with that call, who spoke on the condition of anonymity because the information had not been announced publicly.

“Within hours of taking office I will sign dozens of executive orders, close to a hundred to be exact, many of which I will be describing in my address tomorrow,” Trump said at a dinner for people who had donated to the inauguration festivities. “With a stroke of my pen I will revoke dozens of destructive and radical executive orders and actions of the Biden administration.”

Lawmakers are expected to

SEE TRUMP ON A6

Teed up: Orders being readied take aim at federal workforce. **A2**

Hostage releases mark first hours of ceasefire



TOMER APPELBAUM/VIA REUTERS

Emily Damari, one of the released Israeli hostages, reaches out to a loved one from a vehicle in Ramat Gan, Israel.

Joy and grief as Gazans return to communities of rubble

BY CLAIRE PARKER, HAJAR HARB, MOHAMAD EL CHAMAA AND HEBE FAROUK MAHFOUZ

JERUSALEM — The skies over Gaza finally went quiet for the first time in 14 months Sunday as a fragile ceasefire took hold.

The whine of Israeli drones — the soundtrack of more than a year of war — receded. Hamas fighters emerged into the day-

light, wearing masks and wielding guns atop pickup trucks, to the cheers of civilians. Displaced Gazans marched in the thousands down dusty roads from makeshift shelters to the hometowns they had fled as the Israeli army advanced.

Joy mingled with grief as Gazans began to confront the scale of the loss: Homes reduced to rubble. The bodies of loved ones still buried under the debris.

Whole communities flattened. And scars, visible and not, from the war’s human toll: More than 46,900 dead and 110,750 injured, according to the Gaza Health Ministry. The ministry does not distinguish between civilians and combatants, but says the majority of the dead are women and children.

Israel launched the campaign after Hamas-led fighters from Gaza carried out a surprise at-

tack against Israeli communities near the enclave on Oct. 7, 2023, killing about 1,200 people, most of them civilians, and taking 250 more as hostages.

The northern Gaza city of Jabalya bore the brunt of Israel’s military operations in recent months.

“We congratulate our people on the ceasefire; it would not have been possible without the

SEE GAZA ON A14

90 PALESTINIANS FREED IN EXCHANGE

3 Israeli captives let out as negotiations continue

BY GERRY SHIH, SHIRA RUBIN AND MIRIAM BERGER

JERUSALEM — After 15 months of war, a ceasefire in the Gaza Strip took effect Sunday morning, paving the way for a dramatic day that saw Hamas free the first of 33 Israeli hostages — three women who had languished in captivity for 471 days.

In exchange, Israel released 90 Palestinian prisoners, all of them women and children, early Monday to families that had waited in the cold outside the Ofer Prison in the West Bank.

The ceasefire was initially scheduled to begin at 8:30 a.m. Sunday, but was delayed after Hamas was late to provide the hostages’ names to mediators, and Israel carried out last-minute strikes against the militant group’s facilities, the Israeli military said.

Eventually, the guns fell silent. And once Israel announced that the ceasefire would begin at 11:15 a.m., Palestinians launched into jubilant celebrations in the streets of Gaza while Israelis streamed into the Tel Aviv plaza known as “Hostages Square” to await the return of the first three hostages, identified as Roni Gonen, 24; Emily Tehila Damari, 28; and Doron Steinbrecher, 31.

A total of 33 Israeli hostages, most of whom are presumed to be alive, will be gradually freed every seven days over the next 42 days under the ceasefire agreement’s first phase.

If negotiations over the more politically fraught second phase succeed in the coming weeks and

SEE CEASEFIRE ON A14

TikTok back after brief U.S. shutdown

Trump said he would issue an order to delay the ban passed last year

BY CRISTIANO LIMA-STRONG

TikTok said it was working to bring the platform back online Sunday after President-elect Donald Trump vowed to halt a federal ban against the app once he takes office, a stunning reversal just 14 hours after the social media platform went dark for its millions of users in the United States.

“In agreement with our service providers, TikTok is in the process of restoring service,” the company said in a statement. “We thank President Trump for providing the necessary clarity and assurance to our service providers that they will face no penalties providing TikTok to over 170 million Americans and allowing over 7 million small businesses to thrive.”

The action marked the latest dizzying development in the battle over the fate of the app, which has entranced millions of users with its snappy, short-form videos but sparked condemnation from officials across Washington — including Trump when he was president — over its links to China.

Trump confirmed Sunday that

SEE TIKTOK ON A6



CAITLIN O'HARA FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Maria Isabel Ramirez prepares dinner with the help of sons Alex, 18, and Andy, 20, this month in Glendale, Arizona. “I’m like Arizona. I’m the pendulum,” she says of her swing-voter status.

‘We’re not putting our guard down’

For one Latino family, votes for Trump aren’t long-term GOP allegiance

BY SABRINA RODRIGUEZ IN GLENDALE, ARIZ.

When Maria Isabel Ramirez crossed the U.S.-Mexico border, she dreamed of becoming financially secure enough to send money to her parents back in Mexico. She hoped that she would be able to raise a family in what she calls a “country of dreams” and that her children would find success here.

More than three decades later, sitting in her Phoenix-area living room on a recent Saturday afternoon, her face lights up as she and her husband, Alfonso, flip through family photos and videos on their phones: her youngest son, Alexan-

der, in his regalia when he graduated from high school. Alex and his older brother, Andy, at a recent football game. One of their dog Bella’s recent litters of puppies.

Maria Isabel then paused on another fairly recent memory: a video of her and Andy at a campaign rally for Donald Trump. She recalled how hot it was, waiting in line for hours on a scorching summer day. It was worth it, she said, to see the man she believes will protect and strengthen the country she calls home.

“We want it to still be a strong country,” she said. “For me, since I was in Mexico, I always looked at the United States as something big —

SEE FAMILY ON A4

Border chaos: After running on immigration, Donald Trump will have to actually govern on the issue. **A3**

L.A. neglected crucial wildfire team for years

Red tape, budget issues smothered hiring push, Post investigation finds

This article is by Aaron C. Davis, Shawn Boburg, Brianna Sacks, Molly Hennessy-Fiske and Joyce Sohyun Lee

Two years before wildfires incinerated swaths of Los Angeles, the city’s fire chief, Kristin M. Crowley, identified “one significant area of weakness” in her department’s ability to contain wildfires. L.A. had no specialized wildland unit to respond to daily brush fires and scrape vegetation, dig ditches and do the other labor to ensure blazes did not spread or rekindle, she wrote on Jan. 5, 2023, asking for \$7 million to assemble its own squad.

In a memo that has not been previously reported, she told city fire commissioners that L.A. relied almost entirely on overburdened “hand crews” from other jurisdictions to bring such muscle to its brush fire emergencies. Hand crews, the most elite of which are sometimes called “hot-shots,” fight wildfires with chain saws, axes and shovels, setting containment lines and then sticking around to meticulously monitor smoldering fires, feeling by hand for heat and digging out live spots to make sure fires don’t relight.

The city staffed its own team — made up of unpaid, mostly teenage volunteers — only on Tuesdays and Thursdays after school.

Crowley warned the commission that there would inevitably come a day when L.A. would need the important grunt work of a “hand crew” and one would not be available, which could “mean the difference in containment or out of control spread.”

Yet as fire swept down from the Santa Monica mountains this month, L.A. still had no professional unit ready to aid in the initial attack, according to a Washington Post review of dozens of city and county records, hours of radio transmissions and L.A. fire commission transcripts, as well as interviews with more than a dozen firefighters and city officials. More than three years after the fire department’s first request, the city had only recently advertised openings for at least two dozen openings on a team whose launch was delayed because of bureaucracy and competing budget priorities.

This gap in L.A.’s firefighting arsenal provides a new window into how the metropolis failed to reckon with the threat posed by wildfires intensified by climate change. It is unclear whether those additional units would have altered the course of the conflagrations, or have better put out a small blaze now under investigation for possibly reigniting and sparking the Palisades Fire. But had the proposed plans come to fruition, the city would have had

SEE FIRES ON A11

‘Everything is gone’: How do they start over after losing it all? **A12**

Volunteers: A massive force is serving victims, responders. **A12**

IN THE NEWS

A parting message President Joe Biden visited South Carolina as he prepared to leave office, vowing to keep fighting for equity. **A5**

Garland’s legacy The nation’s outgoing attorney general embraced a by-the-book approach that drew sharp criticism from both the left and the right. **A9**

THE NATION Biden posthumously pardoned Marcus Garvey and granted six others clemency. **A3**
President-elect Donald Trump made a triumphant appearance at Capital One Arena. **A10**

THE WORLD Items recovered from dead North Korean troops give Ukraine an idea of their mindset. **A13**
Israel has damaged or destroyed hundreds of buildings in Lebanon amid a ceasefire. **A15**

THE ECONOMY A self-described whistle-blower is arguing to regulators that Amazon illegally disguised what was effectively an acquisition because it was liable to be blocked. **A16**

THE REGION Bills aim to regulate the growth of data centers in Virginia. **B1**

As the inauguration and Martin Luther King Jr. Day converge, some will gather to celebrate Trump as others honor the civil rights icon. **B1**
Among those convicted in the Capitol riot, 16 people serving the longest sentences may stand to gain the most from potential pardons. **B1**

STYLE As Kamala Harris’s tenure as vice president ends, the public is finally getting a look at her official residence. **C1**

SPORTS The Commanders will visit Philadelphia to play for the NFC title Sunday after the Eagles eliminated the Rams. **D1**

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